

Unit - 4

THEME DEVELOPMENT

Anatomy of a Theme

Document Head (header.php)

- The opening <html> tag should include language_attributes().
- The <meta> charset element should be placed before everything else, including the <title> element.
- Use bloginfo() to set the <meta> charset and description elements.
- Use wp_title() to set the <title> element.
- Add a call to wp_head() before the closing </head> tag.

Plugins use this action hook to add their own scripts, stylesheets, and other functionality.

```
<!DOCTYPE html> <html <?php language_attributes(); ?>>  
<head>  
<meta charset="<?php bloginfo( 'charset' ); ?>" />  
<title><?php wp_title(); ?></title>  
<?php wp_head(); ?>  
</head>
```

Anatomy of a Theme

Widgets (sidebar.php)

- The Theme should be widgetized as fully as possible. Any area in the layout that works like a widget (tag cloud, blogroll, list of categories) or could accept widgets (sidebar) should allow widgets.
- Content that appears in widgetized areas by default (hard-coded into the sidebar, for example) should disappear when widgets are enabled from Appearance > Widgets.

```
<aside id="sidebar" class="widget-area">
```

```
<?php if ( is_active_sidebar( 'main-sidebar' ) ) : ?>
```

```
<?php dynamic_sidebar( 'main-sidebar' ); ?>
```

```
<?php else : ?>
```

```
<p>Add widgets via Appearance > Widgets.</p>
```

```
<?php endif; ?></aside>
```

Anatomy of a Theme

Footer (footer.php)

Use the `wp_footer()` call, to appear just before closing body tag.

```
<?php wp_footer(); ?>  
</body></html>
```

Common Template Parts:

File	Purpose
header.php	Top section: metadata, site title, logo, navigation, etc.
footer.php	Bottom section: copyright, footer nav, scripts, etc.
sidebar.php	Sidebar: widgets, categories, search, recent posts, etc.

Template Files List

style.css

The main stylesheet. This must be included with your Theme, and it must contain the information header for your Theme.

index.php

The main template. If your Theme provides its own templates, index.php must be present.

comments.php

The comments template.

front-page.php

The front page template.

home.php

The home page template, which is the front page by default. If you use a static front page this is the template for the page with the latest posts.

Template Files List

single.php

The single post template. Used when a single post is queried. For this and all other query templates, index.php is used if the query template is not present.

page.php

The page template. Used when an individual Page is queried.

category.php

The category template. Used when a category is queried.

tag.php

The tag template. Used when a tag is queried.

author.php

The author template. Used when an author is queried.

date.php

The date/time template. Used when a date or time is queried.
Year, month, day, hour, minute, second.

Template Files List

archive.php

The archive template. Used when a category, author, or date is queried. Note that this template will be overridden by category.php, author.php, and date.php for their respective query types.

search.php

The search results template. Used when a search is performed.

attachment.php

Attachment template. Used when viewing a single attachment.

image.php

Image attachment template. Used when viewing a single image attachment. If not present, attachment.php will be used.

404.php

The 404 Not Found template. Used when WordPress cannot find a post or page that matches the query.

The Loop

The Loop is PHP code used by WordPress to display posts. Using The Loop, WordPress processes each post to be displayed on the current page, and formats it according to how it matches specified criteria within The Loop tags. Any HTML or PHP code in the Loop will be processed on each post.

The Loop displays the following information by default for each post:

Title : `the_title()` , Time : `the_time()` , Categories : `the_category()`

Example

```
<?php
if ( have_posts() ) {
    while ( have_posts() ) {
        the_post();
        // Post Content here
    } // end while
} // end if ?>
```

General tags

wp_head()

wp_head function is known as “action hook”. Action hooks are placeholders where code is dynamically added to a theme. The wp_head function act as placeholders for plugins to insert code to the <head> of the theme respectively.

How to add wp_head to a WordPress theme

To add the wp_head function correctly to your WordPress theme, simply open your theme’s header.php file and add the following line of PHP code right before the closing head tag (</head>):

Example : <?php wp_head();?>

General tags

wp_title()

The wp_title filter is used to filter the title of the page (called with wp_title()). This filters the text appearing in the HTML <title> tag (sometimes called the “title tag” or “meta title”), not the post, page, or category title.

How to add wp_title to a WordPress theme

Display blog title after page/post title:

Example

```
<title><?php wp_title(' '); echo ' | '; bloginfo('name' );?></title>
```

General tags

get_header()

Includes the header.php template file from your current theme's directory.

If the theme contains no header.php file then the header from the default theme wp-includes/theme-compat/header.php will be included.

Usage

```
<?php get_header( $name ); ?>
```

General tags

get_footer()

Includes the footer.php template file from your current theme's directory.

If the theme contains no footer.php file then the footer from the default theme wp-includes/theme-compat/footer.php will be included.

Usage

```
<?php get_footer( $name ); ?>
```

General tags

get_sidebar()

Includes the sidebar template for a theme or if a name is specified then a specialised sidebar will be included.

Usage

Left and Right Sidebars

Two sidebars in one theme.

```
<?php get_sidebar( 'left' ); ?>
```

```
<?php get_sidebar( 'right' ); ?>
```

General tags

`get_search_form()`

Will first attempt to locate the `searchform.php` file. If it doesn't exist, then the default search form will be displayed. The default search form is HTML, which will be displayed.

This function is primarily used by themes which want to hardcode the search form into the sidebar and also by the search widget in WordPress.

❑ `get_search_form()` displays the search box.

Uses `searchform.php` if available, otherwise defaults to WordPress's built-in form.

Usage

```
<?php get_search_form(); ?>
```

General tags

bloginfo()

Displays information about the current site.

Possible values for show :

‘name’ – Displays the “Site Title” set in Settings > General.

‘description’ – Displays the “Tagline” set in Settings > General.

‘wpurl’ – Displays the “WordPress address (URL)” set in Settings > General.

‘url’ – Displays the “Site address (URL)” set in Settings > General.

‘admin_email’ – Displays the “E-mail address” set in Settings > General.

General tags

‘charset’ – Displays the “Encoding for pages and feeds” set in Settings > Reading.

‘version’ – Displays the WordPress Version you use.

‘html_type’ – Displays the Content-Type of WordPress HTML pages (default: “text/html”).

‘language’ – Displays the language of WordPress.

‘stylesheet_url’ – Displays the primary CSS (usually *style.css*) file URL of the active theme.

‘template_url’ / **‘template_directory’** – URL of the active theme’s directory.

‘rss_url’ – Displays the Atom feed URL (*/feed/atom*).

General tags

single_post_title()

Display or retrieve page title for post.

This is optimized for single.php template file for displaying the post title.

Example

```
<h2><?php single_post_title( 'Current post: ' ); ?></h2>
```

Result:

Current post: Single Post Title

Example in header.php

You can use it in <title> tags for single posts:

```
<title>
```

```
    <?php if ( is_single() )  
    { single_post_title();  
    } else { bloginfo( 'name' ); } ?> </title>
```

General tags

comments_template()

Filters the path to the theme template file used for the comments template. The `comments_template()` template tag sets up the commenting variables and functions, and includes the `comments.php` template-part file.

Example

Normally, you place it in your **single post template** (`single.php`, `page.php`, etc.) after the content:

```
<?php if ( comments_open() ||  
get_comments_number() )  
{ comments_template(); } ?>
```

General tags

add_theme_support()

When creating a new theme or customising an existing one, you might find it helpful to make use of the `add_theme_support()` function that is already integrated into WordPress.

Registers theme support for a given feature. Must be called in the theme's `functions.php` file to work. Theme Features is a set of specific functionality that may be enabled by theme authors.

List of Features

Content Width, Automatic Feed Links, Custom Backgrounds, Custom Headers, Post Formats, Title Tag, Theme Logo, Sidebars, Navigation Menus

Example

```
<?php add_theme_support( 'custom-background' );  
add_theme_support( 'custom-logo' ); ?>
```

General tags

`get_template_directory_uri()`

Always return the URI of the current parent theme.

it is a **WordPress function** that returns the **URL** of your theme's root directory (the *parent theme*, not the child theme).

Useful when you need to load CSS, JS, or image files from your theme.

Example

```

```

Link to a CSS file

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="<?php echo  
get_template_directory_uri(); ?>/style.css">
```

General tags

body_class()

Display the classes for the body element. This function gives the body element different classes and can be added, typically, in the header.php's HTML body tag.

Syntax

```
<body <?php body_class( $class ); ?>>
```

\$class (*optional*) → A string or array of additional custom classes you want to add.

Basic Usage

The following example shows how to implement the body_class template tag into a theme.

```
<body <?php body_class(); ?>>
```

Author tags

the_author()

Display the name of the author of the current post.

Usage

```
<p>This post was written by <?php the_author(); ?></p>
```

get_the_author()

Retrieve the author of the current post.

Usage

```
<?php $author = get_the_author(); ?>
```

Author tags

the_author_link()

If the author has a home page set, echo an HTML link, otherwise just echo the author's name. The **Website** field is set in the user's profile.

Usage

<p>Written by: <?php the_author_link(); ?></p>

get_the_author_link()

Retrieve either author's link or author's name.

Usage

<p>Written by: <?php echo get_the_author_link(); ?></p>

Author tags

the_author_meta()

The the_author_meta Template Tag displays a desired meta data field for a user. Only one field is returned at a time, you need to specify which you want.

Usage

```
<?php $authorDesc = the_author_meta('description');  
echo $authorDesc; ?>
```

Author tags

the_author_posts()

Display the number of posts by the author of the current post.

Usage

```
<p><?php the_author(); ?> has blogged  
<?php the_author_posts(); ?> posts</p>
```

Category tags

category_description()

Displays the description of a category, given its id, by echoing the return value of the tag. If no category given and used on a category page, it returns the description of the current category.

Usage

```
<div><?php echo category_description(3); ?></div>
```

Category tags

`single_cat_title()`

Useful for category template files for displaying the category page title.

Example :

This example displays the text “Currently browsing ” followed by the category title.

```
<p><?php single_cat_title('Currently browsing '); ?>.</p>
```

Result:

Currently browsing WordPress.

Category tags

the_category()

Display category list for a post in either HTML list or custom format.

Example :

Separated by Space

List categories with a space as the separator.

```
<?php the_category( ' ' ); ?>
```

Separated by Comma

Displays links to categories, each category separated by a comma (if more than one).

```
<?php the_category( ', ' ); ?>
```

Link tags

the_permalink()

Displays the URL for the permalink to the post currently being processed in The Loop. This tag must be within The Loop, and is generally used to display the permalink for each post, when the posts are being displayed.

Example :

Display Post URL as Text

This address for this post is: `<?php the_permalink(); ?>`

Link tags

`get_permalink()`

Retrieves the full permalink for the current post or post ID.

Example :

Get current post/page url outside loop. `$post` is a global variable.

```
<?php echo get_permalink( $post->ID ); ?>
```

Link tags

home_url()

Retrieves the URL for the current site where the front end is accessible.

Example :

```
$url = home_url();  
echo $url;
```

Output: http://www.example.com

Link tags

`get_home_url()`

Retrieves the URL for the current site where the front end is accessible.

Basic Usage

```
<?php echo get_home_url(); ?>
```

Output: `http://www.example.com`

Link tags

site_url ()

Retrieves the URL for the current site where WordPress application files are accessible.

Examples

```
$url = site_url();
```

```
echo $url;
```

Output: `http://www.example.com` or
`http://www.example.com/wordpress`

Link tags

`get_site_url ()`

Retrieves the URL for the current site where WordPress application files are accessible.

Examples

```
<?php echo get_site_url(); ?>
```

Results in the full site URL being displayed:

`http://www.example.com/wordpress`

Post tags

the_content()

Display the post content.

Examples

```
<?php the_content( 'Read more ...' ); ?>
```

Post tags

the_excerpt()

Returns the excerpt (**summary**) of the post. This is either a user-supplied excerpt, that is returned unchanged, or an automatically generated word-counted trimmed-down version of the full post content.

Examples

```
<?php the_excerpt(); ?>
```

Post tags

the_ID()

Display the ID of the current item in the WordPress Loop.

Examples

```
<p>Post Number: <?php the_ID(); ?></p>
```

the_tags()

Retrieve the tags for a post.

Examples

```
<p><?php the_tags(); ?></p>
```

Post tags

the_title()

Display or retrieve the current post title.

Examples

```
<?php the_title( '<h3>', '</h3>' ); ?>
```

get_the_title()

Retrieve post title.

Examples

```
<?php echo get_the_title(); ?>
```

Post tags

the_date()

Displays or returns the date of a post, or a set of posts if published on the same day.

Examples

Date as Year, Month, Date in Heading

Displays the date using the '2007-07-23' format (ex: 2004-11-30), inside an <h2> tag.

```
<?php the_date('Y-m-d', '<h2>', '</h2>'); ?>
```

Post tags

`get_the_date()`

Retrieve the date on which the post was written.

Examples

To make the date appear as “Monday January 11, 2017”, for example, use

```
$post_date = get_the_date( 'l F j, Y' ); echo $post_date;
```

Post tags

the_time()

Displays the time of the current post.

Examples

Time as AM/PM VS. 24H format

Displays the time using the format parameter string 'g:i a' (ex: 10:36 pm).

<p>Time posted: <?php the_time('g:i a'); ?></p>

Post tags

next_post_link()

Prints a link to the next set of posts within the current query.

Examples

```
<?php next_post_link( '<strong>%link</strong>' ); ?>
```

previous_post_link()

Prints a link to the previous set of posts within the current query.

Examples

```
<?php previous_post_link( '<strong>%link</strong>' ); ?>
```

Post tags

posts_nav_link()

Displays the post pages link navigation for previous and next pages.

Examples

Displays previous and next page links (“previous page · next page”) centered on the page.

```
<div style="text-align:center;">  
    <?php posts_nav_link( ' · ', 'previous page', 'next page' ); ?>  
</div>
```

Post tags

post_class()

Display the classes for the post div.

Examples

```
<div id="post-<?php the_ID(); ?>" <?php post_class(); ?>>
```

Post Thumbnail tags

has_post_thumbnail()

Check if post has an image attached.

Examples

```
<?php if (has_post_thumbnail( $post->ID ) ): ?>
```

get_post_thumbnail_id()

Retrieve post thumbnail ID.

Examples

```
<?php echo get_post_thumbnail_id() ?>
```

Post Thumbnail tags

the_post_thumbnail()

Display the post thumbnail.

Examples

```
<?php the_post_thumbnail( 'large','style=max-width:100%;  
height:auto;'); ?>
```

get_the_post_thumbnail()

Retrieve the post thumbnail.

Examples

```
<?php echo get_the_post_thumbnail( $post->ID, 'thumbnail'  
); ?>
```

Navigation Menu tags

wp_nav_menu()

Displays a navigation menu.

Examples

```
<?php  
wp_nav_menu( array('menu' => 'Project Nav') );  
?>
```

Conditional Tags

is_archive()

Is the query for an existing archive page? This Conditional Tag checks if any type of Archive page is being displayed. It returns either TRUE or FALSE.

Examples

```
<?php  
if ( is_archive() ) {  
    // write your code here ...  
}  
?>
```

Conditional Tags

is_category()

Is the query for an existing category archive page?

Examples

```
<?php
```

```
is_category();
```

```
// When any Category archive page is being displayed.
```

```
is_category( '9' );
```

```
// When the archive page for Category 9 is being displayed.
```

```
?>
```

Conditional Tags

is_front_page()

This Conditional Tag checks if the main page is a posts or a Page. This is a boolean function, meaning it returns either TRUE or FALSE.

Examples

```
<title>
```

```
<?php is_front_page(); ?>
```

```
</title>
```

Conditional Tags

is_home()

The blog homepage is the page that shows the time-based blog content of the site. This function will return true only on the page you set as the "Posts page".

Examples

```
if ( is_home() ) {  
    // This is the blog posts index  
    get_sidebar( 'blog' );  
} else {  
    // This is not the blog posts index  
    get_sidebar();  
}
```

Conditional Tags

is_page()

Is the query for an existing single page?

Examples

// When any single Page is being displayed.

```
is_page();
```

// When Page 42 (ID) is being displayed.

```
is_page( 42 );
```

// When the Page with a post_title of "Contact" is being displayed.

```
is_page( 'Contact' );
```

Conditional Tags

is_single()

Is the query for an existing single post?

Examples

```
is_single();
```

// When any single Post page is being displayed.

```
is_single('17');
```

// When Post 17 (ID) is being displayed.

Conditional Tags

is_search()

Is the query for a search?

Examples

```
if ( is_search() ) {  
    // add external search form (Google, Yahoo, Bing...)  
}
```

Conditional Tags

is_attachment()

This Conditional Tag checks if an attachment is being displayed. An attachment is an image or other file uploaded through the post editor's upload utility.

Examples

```
<?php
if ( is_attachment() ) {
// show adv. #1
}
else {
// show adv. #2
}
?>
```

Conditional Tags

is_active_sidebar()

This Conditional Tag checks if a given sidebar is active (in use). This is a boolean function, meaning it returns either TRUE or FALSE.

Examples

```
<?php
if ( is_active_sidebar( 'left-sidebar' ) ) {
?>
    <ul id="sidebar">
        <?php dynamic_sidebar( 'left-sidebar' ); ?>
    </ul>
<?php }
?>
```

function.php in wordpress

One way to change the default behaviors of WordPress is using a file named `functions.php`. It goes in your Theme's folder.

The functions file behaves like a WordPress Plugin, adding features and functionality to a WordPress site. You can use it to call functions, both PHP and built-in WordPress, and to define your own functions. You can produce the same results by adding code to a WordPress Plugin or through the WordPress Theme functions file.

A functions file:

- Requires no unique Header text.
- Is stored with each Theme in the Theme's subdirectory in `wp-content/themes`.
- Executes only when in the currently activated theme's directory.
- Applies only to that theme. If the Theme is changed, the functionality is lost.
- Can have numerous blocks of code used for many different purposes.